

Skills Summary

Adding Story Problems

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Act Out the Story

Rule: An add-to story starts with some things, and then more come. Show it! Draw a shape for each thing in the start, then a shape for each thing that comes, and count them all.

Example: 2 birds sit in a tree. 3 more birds fly in. How many birds now?

Step 1. The story adds more birds, so we draw the start, draw what comes, and count everything.

Step 2. Draw 2 circles, then 3 more circles. Count: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 — so $2 + 3 = 5$. ✓
⇒ there are **5** birds

Try it: 4 cats nap on a rug. 2 more cats join them. Draw it and count. How many cats?

check: 6

Skill 2 — Write the Equation

Rule: The two story numbers go into the equation, and the answer is the total: start + more = total.

Example: 3 fish swim in a tank. 4 more fish are added. Write the equation and solve it.

Step 1. The start number is 3 and the more number is 4, so those two numbers go into the equation.

Step 2. $3 + 4 = ?$ Count on from 4: 5, 6, 7. So $3 + 4 = 7$. ✓
⇒ $3 + 4 = 7$

Try it: 5 ducks are in the pond, and 4 more waddle in. Write the equation and solve it.

check: 9

Skill 3 — Count On to Solve

Rule: Start at one number and count on the other. Start with the **bigger** number — fewer counts means fewer chances to slip!

Example: $6 + 2$

Step 1. Counting on is fastest from the bigger number, so we start at 6 and count on 2.

Step 2. Say 6, then count: 7, 8. So $6 + 2 = 8$. ✓
⇒ $6 + 2 = 8$

Try it: $2 + 7$ (start from the bigger number!)

check: 9

(!) Watch out: When you count on, do not say the start number as a count. For $6 + 2$, say “6” — then count “7, 8”. Counting “6, 7” lands one short!